

Chapter 8

Hack College (Or Just Skip It)

“You have brains in your head. You have feet in your shoes. You can steer yourself any direction you choose. You're on your own. And you know what you know. And YOU are the one who'll decide where to go . . .” –Dr. Seuss, Oh, the Places You'll Go!

This book is not out to bash college. Brad, Jonathan, and I all have college degrees. For Brad and me, those degrees were instrumental in our paths to FI. But “hacking college” is a common pattern among the people profiled in this book. “Hacking college” means getting degrees that enable high-paying jobs while accruing little to no student debt. Alternatively, you can accumulate valuable skills without getting a college degree. While income is important, the ability to save a high percentage of that income because we’re not handcuffed by high student loan payments is even more important.